

OPEN PARISH MEETING 55 people attended last Tuesday's meeting. Minutes will be available in due course. Our thanks to all who contributed to the discussions as well as those who gave presentations. There was plenty to think about and actions which will be required. The financial accounts of our three parishes are now at the back of each church.

OUR LADY'S HALL The Hall will close at the end of this month. All the groups which regularly use it have been notified. The Family Centre has played a huge part in the life of the Catholic Community and the Town. Many socialised there when they came to the Garden City. A large number met their spouses there and their children made lifelong friends in the Centre. For others it served as a venue for Wedding Receptions and Funeral Receptions. There have been dances, pantomimes, concerts and plays. A huge amount of charitable work and fundraising has taken place. Our thanks to Fr. Michael Groarke for his vision all those years ago and to the priests and committee members who have given of themselves to serve the wider Community. In recent years there has been the Pomegranate Café and many social occasions flowing from the celebration of Mass. To mark the completion of this chapter, there will be a Get-together in the Lounge on Saturday 6th October after 6pm Mass. Please bring food to share. Those coming are invited to bring photos and mementos and thus have a chance to catch up with others and give thanks to God for all the blessings received.

SECONDARY SCHOOL TRANSFER Fr. Norbert urges parent/s to visit Secondary Schools with their child and to reflect on which school will help their child flourish. For those applying to Catholic Schools a Certificate of Catholicity is required which affirms that a child comes from a practising Catholic family, i.e. a family which attends Mass every week. It is crucial to read a school's admissions policy to see if your child has a good chance of getting in. Fr. Norbert will be available in October to sign the Certificate of Catholicity Forms: Wednesday 10th 4.00 - 6.00pm, Monday 15th 4.00 - 6.30pm and Tuesday 23rd 4.00 - 6.30pm. Please make an appointment with Kathryn Hubbard for a 10-minute slot. Parent/s and child should come to Our Lady's Church and wait to be called. In due course there will be the 'extra' form at the back of our churches which will need to be filled and brought to the meeting.

RCIA Are you interested in joining the Catholic Church or knowing more? Are you a Catholic adult who missed out on Confirmation when you were younger? Now's the time to think about the next steps! Pray. Talk to another Catholic. Come to Church and deepen your experience of being with others. The first session for our three parishes will be on Monday 1st October at 7.30pm in Our Lady's Sacristy.

CONFIRMATION Enrolment of young people for Confirmation will be in Holy Family Church on Sunday 21st October at 7pm. Young people should be at least in Year 9 at school. Parents are asked to come to this meeting with their son or daughter. The meeting will last one hour.

FIRST HOLY COMMUNION Enrolment for St. Bonaventure's First Confession and First Holy Communion will be in the Parish Hall of St. Bonaventure's on Saturday 13th October at 11am. The children's sessions are once a month on a Saturday and will begin the following Saturday (20th October). Enrolment for Our Lady's Church will be on Tuesday 27th November at 7.45pm in Our Lady's Church (children do not have to attend); the sessions are on a Sunday morning starting in the new year. Enrolment for Holy Family Church will be on Sunday 2nd December after 9.30 Mass. (Holy Family's sessions begin in the new year and are usually after school midweek).

PRAYER SERVICE OF REMEMBRANCE Saturday 3rd November 12.00 at St Bonaventure's. We would like to invite you and your family and friends to join us for a short Service of Prayer to remember our loved ones who have died and comfort for all who mourn them. Tea/coffee and a chance to meet after the Service in the Parish Hall. The Bereavement Group

VACANCY Holy Family School requires Meal Supervisors to work lunchtimes in the dining hall. Please contact 01707 375518 for an application pack.